

# Parent Meal Prep Monotony — Action Checklist

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PRINT THIS PAGE AND KEEP IT SOMEWHERE VISIBLE

## RUN YOUR SUNDAY MEAL PREP SESSION

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- ☐ **Set a 2-hour timer and commit to batch-cooking foundation foods on Sunday afternoon to turn weekday cooking into simple assembly. This removes the mental load of daily cooking decisions and uses your time efficiently when you have it.:** Set a 2-hour timer and commit to batch-cooking foundation foods on Sunday afternoon to turn weekday cooking into simple assembly. This removes the mental load of daily cooking decisions and uses your time efficiently when you have it.
- ☐ **Bake a double batch of meatballs during the first hour while prepping roasted vegetables during the second hour to maximize your Sunday session efficiency. Meatballs freeze flat in single layers and reheat perfectly in a skillet with sauce.:** Bake a double batch of meatballs during the first hour while prepping roasted vegetables during the second hour to maximize your Sunday session efficiency. Meatballs freeze flat in single layers and reheat perfectly in a skillet with sauce.
- ☐ **Prepare a simple marinara sauce or taco soup in the second hour and portion it into ice cube trays for easy thawing throughout the week. Sauces and gravies freeze beautifully and add flavor to multiple meals without requiring fresh cooking.:** Prepare a simple marinara sauce or taco soup in the second hour and portion it into ice cube trays for easy thawing throughout the week. Sauces and gravies freeze beautifully and add flavor to multiple meals without requiring fresh cooking.
- ☐ **Cook and freeze pancakes or waffles in stacks during the last 30 minutes of your session for quick weekday breakfasts that reheat in the toaster. Label everything with the date before storing it in the freezer.:** Cook and freeze pancakes or waffles in stacks during the last 30 minutes of your session for quick weekday breakfasts that reheat in the toaster. Label everything with the date before storing it in the freezer.

## BUILD YOUR 4-WEEK ROTATION SCHEDULE

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- ❑ **Print or write out the 4-week breakfast rotation table and post it on your fridge so every family member knows what's for breakfast each day. This removes the daily what-are-we-eating question entirely from your mornings.:** Print or write out the 4-week breakfast rotation table and post it on your fridge so every family member knows what's for breakfast each day. This removes the daily what-are-we-eating question entirely from your mornings.
- ❑ **Plan your 15-meal dinner rotation by writing down the 15 kid-approved meals and cycling through them in any order that works for your family. After 4 weeks, restart the rotation without it feeling stale.:** Plan your 15-meal dinner rotation by writing down the 15 kid-approved meals and cycling through them in any order that works for your family. After 4 weeks, restart the rotation without it feeling stale.
- ❑ **Create a lunch rotation using simple assembly items like sandwiches, wraps, and pasta salads that take 5 minutes or less to prepare. Include a weekly leftover night on Friday to use dinner remnants and reduce waste.:** Create a lunch rotation using simple assembly items like sandwiches, wraps, and pasta salads that take 5 minutes or less to prepare. Include a weekly leftover night on Friday to use dinner remnants and reduce waste.
- ❑ **Stick to the rotation for at least 4 weeks before evaluating whether it needs adjustment, because 4 weeks is long enough to build the habit and prove the system works for your family.:** Stick to the rotation for at least 4 weeks before evaluating whether it needs adjustment, because 4 weeks is long enough to build the habit and prove the system works for your family.

## MAINTAIN YOUR EMERGENCY BACKUP SYSTEM

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- ❑ **Stock a shelf-stable emergency stash including yogurt pouches, crackers, cheese, canned soup, and boxed mac and cheese for days when you forget to thaw something or life happens. Store these items where they're easily accessible when needed.:** Stock a shelf-stable emergency stash including yogurt pouches, crackers, cheese, canned soup, and boxed mac and cheese for days when you forget to thaw something or life happens. Store these items where they're easily accessible when needed.
- ❑ **Keep frozen pizza and other emergency entrees on hand for sick days or weeks when cooking feels impossible, and note when you use these items so you can restock before the next crisis. This is not a regular part of your rotation but a genuine safety net.:** Keep frozen pizza and other emergency entrees on hand for sick days or weeks when cooking feels impossible, and note when you use these items so you can restock before the next crisis. This is not a regular part of your rotation but a genuine safety net.

- **Label all frozen meal prep items with the date before storing them, and check your freezer monthly to use items before they exceed the 2-3 month quality window. Most foundation foods lose quality beyond that timeframe.:** Label all frozen meal prep items with the date before storing them, and check your freezer monthly to use items before they exceed the 2-3 month quality window. Most foundation foods lose quality beyond that timeframe.
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- **After your first 4-week rotation cycle, take 10 minutes to note which meals your kids actually ate and which ones they rejected, then adjust your 15-meal dinner list accordingly. The system only works if the meals on your list are ones your kids will actually eat.:** After your first 4-week rotation cycle, take 10 minutes to note which meals your kids actually ate and which ones they rejected, then adjust your 15-meal dinner list accordingly. The system only works if the meals on your list are ones your kids will actually eat.
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Companion to the full guide in your Lemon Squeezy library — check off each item as you complete it.